

spirits usually carry out Ahura-Mazda's commands. In one respect, at all events, the prophet is decidedly dependent upon Parseeism. When he speaks, namely, of *seven* eyes engraved upon a stone which Jahveh lays before the high-priest;* or of the *seven* arms of the golden candlestick;† or once even—according to a very probable correction of the text—of “*the seven watchers* of Jahveh, which run to and fro through the whole earth”‡—we naturally connect this with the *amešaspenā's* (“non-slumberers”?) who surround Ahura-Mazda and are described as leaders of the heavenly host.§

The doctrine of angels continued to develop among the Jews in the same direction. In the 3rd century before our era we already find traces of belief in guardian angels of single nations.|| A century later the author of the book of Daniel uses the same idea.¶ He, too, is the first who mentions the names of angels,** which proves that men began to think of them more and more in the likeness of man and ascribed to them a personal character, an individuality of their own. The same author uses, to indicate a certain class of heavenly spirits, the word “*watchers*,”†† which we just now believed we had found in Zechariah and which also occurs elsewhere.‡‡ Heaven gradually becomes more thickly populated with a number of higher beings, differing in their rank and the sphere of their activity, charged with a definite task and known by proper names. In some of these it is believed that we have Persian names of angels, translated or adopted with a slight modification.§§ But irrespectively of this, the influence of Parseeism in this increasing abundance of heavenly spirits is unmistakable.

* Zech. iii. 9.

† Zech. iv. 2.

‡ Zech. iv. 10. Usual reading, “the seven *eyes* of Jahveh, &c.” The correction is put forward by Dr. A. Kohut, *über die jüdische Angelologie u. Daemonologie in ihrer Abhängigkeit vom Parsismus*, p. 6, n. 17.

§ Tiele, l. c., pp. 142, seq.

|| Comp. Deut. xxxii. 8 (lxx.); Sirach xvii. 17.

¶ Dan. x. 12, 20, 21; xi. 1; xii. 1.

** Dan. viii. 16; ix. 21 (Gabriel); x. 13, 21; xii. 1 (Michael).

†† Dan. iv. 13, seq.

‡‡ The book of Enoch, chap. xx. seq.

§§ Comp. Kohut, l. c., p. 24, sqq.